Verbal Reference Check: One-Page Form

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Complete one per referee. Ask every safeguarding question as written. File with the written reference. Escalate any concern to the Executive Headmaster and the Designated Safeguarding Lead before informing the candidate.

1. Details

Candidate		Post applied for	
Referee name and title		Organisation	
Relationship to candidate		Dates referee knew candidate	
Caller name and role		Date and time of call	

2. Verification (tick when confirmed)

☐ Referee's number obtained independently of the candidate (switchboard, website, directory)
☐ Referee confirmed they wrote the written reference
☐ Referee is the candidate's Head, Principal or line manager (not HR only, not a peer)

3. Employment

Question	Answer	Matches application?
Dates employed and job title		Yes / No
Reason for leaving		Yes / No
Any probation extension, capability or disciplinary process (upheld or not)?		
Attendance and punctuality		

4. Performance (brief)

Question	Answer
Quality of teaching or professional work, with evidence	
Relationships with pupils, colleagues and parents	
Main strength and one development area	

5. Safeguarding and suitability (mandatory, record a clear yes or no)

Question	Answer
Any allegations, concerns or complaints about behaviour towards children, including any found unsubstantiated or false?	
Any disciplinary sanction relating to child safety or welfare, including expired ones?	
Any concerns about professional boundaries with pupils, in person or online?	
Any concerns in a boarding, residential or trip setting?	
Did they leave while any investigation was ongoing?	
Any reason at all why this person should not work with children?	
Would you re-employ them? If not, why not?	

6. Concerns and inconsistencies

Record anything the referee said that differs from the written reference, application or interview, and any hesitation or reluctance to answer.

7. Outcome

☐ Satisfactory, supports appointment
☐ Satisfactory with follow-up (detail above)
☐ Not satisfactory, escalated, do not confirm offer
☐ Unable to complete, alternative referee requested

Caller signature and date		Executive Headmaster (where any concern is flagged)	